

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

ELECTION 2026 US HOUSE

Field to succeed Davis grows

Congressman backs
legislative ally Ford;
8 others file to run

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Saying it was time for new and younger leadership to take over a congressional district he has represented for nearly three decades, U.S. Rep. Danny Davis announced Thursday he wasn't seeking reelection and endorsed veteran state Rep. La Shawn Ford to succeed him.

"I am 83 years old. Some people won't get to be 83. I mean, a lot of people that I know, and were in my Rolodex, they're not there anymore," Davis said at a news conference outside his West Side congressional office, surrounded by a crush of family, allies and clergy.

"I just decided that this would be a good time — this would be a great time — to try and usher in and help bring in new leadership," he said. "Because when you're on the verge of leaving, it's hard to do the kind of planning you'd like to do."

By retiring at the end of his current term in January 2027, Davis' decision to forgo seeking a 16th term in Congress, as well as the power of seniority that came with being Illinois' longest-serving sitting House member, creates the fourth open-seat congressional contest in Illinois next year.

U.S. Reps. Raja Krishnamoorthi of Schaumburg and

Turn to House, Page 2

Palestinian death toll rises as US envoy lands

By Wafaa Shurafa
and Melanie Lidman
Associated Press

DEIR AL-BALAH, Gaza Strip — President Donald Trump's special envoy Steve Witkoff arrived in Israel on Thursday to discuss the worsening humanitarian situation in Gaza, as the death toll of Palestinians waiting for food and other aid continued to climb.

Witkoff and the U.S. ambassador to Israel, Mike Huckabee, will inspect food distribution in Gaza on Friday, the White House said.

Witkoff met with Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Thursday about the humanitarian situation and a possible ceasefire, according to an official who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive matters.

It was the first meeting between Witkoff and Netanyahu since both Israel and the U.S. called their negotiation teams home from Qatar one week ago. Witkoff said at the time that Hamas "shows a lack of desire" to reach a truce.

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LOLLAPALOOZA DAY 1

"Lollapalooza is like, obviously, one of the largest festivals in America, but in Chicago it has sort of this larger-than-life reputation. It's exciting to be part of the party and get to play one of the big stages at the fest too, it's pretty surreal."

—Julia Steiner, singer-songwriter for Chicago indie-rock band Ratboys



People dance to Azeccca at Perry's stage during Lollapalooza in Chicago's Grant Park on Thursday. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

A little bit country

As festivals go green,
hybrid battery again
powers main stage

By Lily Carey
Chicago Tribune

For the second year in a row, Lollapalooza will power its largest stage with a hybrid battery system, marking a growing trend of big-name music festivals transitioning away from diesel-based generators.

When the Chicago staple introduced its hybrid battery-powered stage in 2024, it became the first major U.S. festival to power its main stage with a battery system, which supplements the stage's generators with energy stored from the electric grid. This system reduced the stage's fuel consumption by 67%, and avoided 26 metric tons of carbon emissions, according to data from festival organizers.

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Kenzie Shultz, of Girl Tones, performs on the BMI stage during Lollapalooza in Grant Park on Thursday.

Chicago hotels hitting a high note

Lollapalooza fans return to Grant Park this weekend, and the wave of visitors should keep most downtown hotel rooms and many restaurants filled, a much-needed boost at a time when overseas tourists seem increasingly reluctant to visit the United States. Chicago hotel operators say it's become one of downtown's most important events, and this year may be the biggest ever. **Business**

Cowboy hats, boots
abounding as Combs
makes Lolla history

By Sophie Levenson,
Kate Perez, Cam'ron Hardy
and Susan Moskop
Chicago Tribune

Lollapalooza opened Thursday in Grant Park for its annual four days of crowds and music, with a lineup through Sunday heavy on female artists — Olivia Rodrigo and Sabrina Carpenter are both end-of-day headliners, with Gracie Abrams and Clairo also among the early crowd favorites.

Official headliners for Day 1 are Tyler, the Creator and Luke Combs, who close out the night on the T-Mobile and Bud Light stages, respectively. Combs will make Lollapalooza history as the Chicago festival's first-ever country music festival closer.

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City's air quality worst in world, at least for 1 day



Smoke from wildfires mutes the skyline as a CTA Green Line train departs the Kedzie station in Chicago on Thursday. JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Canadian wildfires prompt alerts, but experts warn that staying inside isn't a cure-all, either

By Katherine Weaver
Chicago Tribune

Air quality alerts issued Thursday in Illinois because of wildfire smoke marked the latest bout in an increasingly common summer occurrence. The alert covers 34 Illinois counties designated as having unhealthy air for all residents.

Although it is recommended to hunker inside during these stretches, experts say indoor air quality can often be just as bad, if not worse, than outdoor air quality.

"When they're in the home, their windows are closed, the

doors are shut and locked, and they think, 'this is my indoor air, and it's totally different than what's in the outdoor air,'" said Ian Cull, founder and chief science officer of Indoor Science, an indoor air quality consulting and training company headquartered in Aurora. "But homes and all buildings are leakier than what people imagine."

There were two multiday periods of bad air quality in the Midwest earlier this summer — both due to smoke from Canadian wildfires. In June, Chicago saw three days of some of the

Turn to Air, Page 2

A woman who 'lived for others'

Social justice advocate Sister Pat left a legacy of defiant compassion, say mourners who gathered to honor her in Mount Greenwood on Thursday. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Trump active as deadline nears

The tariffs planned by President Donald Trump on Friday touched off a feverish bout of activity among U.S. trade partners as key details remain unclear. **Nation & World**

Cubs' deals shore up pitching

Right-hander Michael Soroka, who headlined a series of moves to add pitching depth, will likely initially join the rotation but could end up in the bullpen. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 76 Low 61

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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